

Wolfspeed

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Semiconductor / Manufacturing
Revenue	\$800M
Employees	4,020
Ideal Customer Profile Score	72

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name Wolfspeed, Inc.

Headquarters Durham, North Carolina

Founded 1987

Ownership

Public (NYSE: WOLF). Post-bankruptcy ownership: former senior secured noteholders (Apollo, Baupost, Fidelity, Capital Group). Renesas converted ~\$2B supply deposit into equity/warrants.

Footprint

Mohawk Valley Fab (Marcy, NY) - primary 200mm production. John Palmour Mfg Center (Siler City, NC) - materials/crystal growth. Durham, NC - corporate HQ and R&D. Germany fab plans abandoned.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Wolfspeed is a global leader in silicon carbide (SiC) semiconductor technology, producing power devices and materials critical to electric vehicles, renewable energy, and 5G infrastructure. Spun off from Cree, the company is investing \$6.5B+ to build next-generation manufacturing capacity.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Wolfspeed's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: FY2024 \$807M -> FY2025 \$758M (-6%). Q2 FY2026 \$168M quarterly. GAAP net loss \$469M FY2025. Mohawk Valley underutilization costs ~\$47M/quarter. Post-restructuring: ~\$2B debt (down from \$4.6B), \$1.3B cash. Received \$698.6M CHIPS Act tax refunds. \$750M CHIPS Act grant preliminary but uncertain. Analyst sentiment: Mixed/cautious. Target: positive unlevered operating cash flow by end FY2026.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Robert Feurle - CEO & Director [PRIORITY TARGET]

30+ years semiconductors. Previously EVP at ams-OSRAM; VP/GM at Infineon; roles at Micron, Qimonda, Siemens. Dual US/German citizen.

Outreach rationale: New CEO (10 months in) leading post-bankruptcy transformation with 20% reduced workforce. Must rebuild trust, align demoralized org around new mission.

Anthony Abate - Board Chairman [PRIORITY TARGET]

Former U.S. Air Force officer (radar/analytics for stealth aircraft). 40+ years in tech/telecom. Chairs GTT Communications, Mitel, Tacora Resources.

Outreach rationale: Air Force veteran - natural affinity for McChrystal. Creditor-appointed chairman with mandate to ensure turnaround delivers. Internal champion/validator.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Gregor van Issum - CFO

20+ years transformation and strategic financing. Previously Chief Transformation Officer at ams-OSRAM; VP Strategy at NXP. Explicitly hired as 'Transformation and Strategic Financing Expert.'

Dr. David Emerson - EVP & COO

Responsible for operational excellence across 200mm footprint.

Margaret Chadwick - SVP & CHRO

Previously at Duke Energy (8 years). BS Business Wake Forest. Longest-tenured C-suite member.

Cengiz Balkas - SVP & Chief Business Officer

PhD Materials Science NC State. 25+ years in SiC materials.

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Wolfspeed operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Transitioning from multi-site R&D-oriented org (legacy Cree, university spinout) to focused high-volume manufacturer running single mega-fab. Near-total leadership turnover: new CEO, CFO, COO, board chairman all within 12 months. COO role newly created June 2025.

Culture Signals

Glassdoor 3.2/5.0 (934 reviews) - below semiconductor avg. Positives: safety culture, state-of-art tech, good benefits. Negatives: 'Disconnect between upper management and those who get work done is breathtaking'; lack of ownership and transparency; frequent team structure changes; still rooted in R&D culture vs. high-volume manufacturing mindset; 'huge employee turnover.' CFO explicitly hired as 'Transformation Expert' - company acknowledges it is in transformation mode.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Wolfspeed.

1. 2024-11-18 - CEO Gregg Lowe ousted after 7 years; board chairman named Executive Chairman

Leadership crisis. Organization lost primary strategic leader amid existential financial pressure.

2. 2024-11-01 - 20% workforce reduction (~1,000+ positions); Durham fab closure; Germany expansion abandoned

Massive organizational trauma. Surviving employees face uncertainty and broken trust.

3. 2025-05-01 - Robert Feurle appointed CEO; Dr. David Emerson joins as first-ever COO (June 2025)

New leader inheriting demoralized, restructured org. Must build trust and alignment fast.

4. 2025-09-29 - Chapter 11 emergence after 91-day prepackaged restructuring; \$4.6B debt eliminated; entire board reconstituted

Post-bankruptcy identity reset. New ownership, board, mandate. Must redefine culture and operating model.

5. 2025-09-01 - Gregor van Issum appointed CFO - explicitly as 'transformation specialist'

Company views itself as in active transformation, not just financial recovery.

6. 2026-02-04 - Q2 FY2026 disappoints; guidance below expectations; additional headcount reduction

Continued pressure means transformation must deliver quickly. No room for slow cultural evolution.

7. 2026-03-01 - Launched industry-first 10kV SiC MOSFET; unveiled 300mm SiC platform for AI data centers

Strategic ambition exists but executing requires organizational alignment that may not yet exist.

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

High-conviction. Post-bankruptcy rebuilding, near-total leadership turnover, manufacturing consolidation, workforce trauma, VUCA environment. Former Air Force officer as board chairman provides natural entry point.

Primary Problem

Multi-dimensional transformation: new leadership team (CEO, CFO, COO, board all replaced in 12 months), post-bankruptcy rebuilding, manufacturing transition (150mm to 200mm, multi-site to mega-fab), cultural shift (R&D to high-volume manufacturing), and strategic pivot (EV-centric to broader markets incl. AI). Workforce has been through layoffs, bankruptcy, CEO firing, and facility closures.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams - breaking silos between Mohawk Valley manufacturing, Siler City materials, sales, and R&D. Leadership development - entirely new C-suite needs rapid trust and shared consciousness. Crisis leadership - CHIPS Act uncertainty, EV demand softness, competitive pressure = VUCA. Culture change - R&D/academic culture (Cree legacy) to disciplined manufacturing execution.

Likely Objections to Engagement

Just went through bankruptcy - can't afford premium consulting

New leadership needs time to settle
Semiconductor company - military consulting not relevant
CFO was already a Chief Transformation Officer

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey - dedicated semiconductor practice
Korn Ferry - leadership assessment / C-suite onboarding
AlixPartners/Alvarez & Marsal - may already be involved (bankruptcy context)
McChrystal differentiator: mission-driven Team of Teams model for post-bankruptcy cultural alignment. Chairman Abate's Air Force background = natural entry.

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

- 1. You've replaced nearly every senior leader and board member in 12 months while consolidating from multiple facilities to a single mega-fab. How are you building shared consciousness and trust across teams operating in fundamentally new ways?**
- 2. Glassdoor and your own hiring patterns suggest Wolfspeed is transitioning from R&D culture to high-volume manufacturing culture. In our experience, that's harder than the technology transition itself. How is that going internally?**
- 3. Your board chairman started his career as an Air Force officer. Our founder built the operating model that transformed Joint Special Operations Command. There may be a shared philosophy about high-performing teams under pressure. Worth exploring?**

Leverage Abate's military background

Recommended Meeting Framing

Position around 'post-restructuring organizational alignment.' Frame: 'Organizations that emerge from Chapter 11 with new leadership and reduced workforce have a 12-18 month window to establish operating norms that determine success. Most fail not because strategy is wrong but because the organization can't execute fast enough. We help close that gap.'

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Wolfspeed's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Value & Competitive Standing: Wolfspeed is the global leader in silicon carbide (SiC) semiconductor

technology - a critical material for electric vehicles, renewable energy, and 5G infrastructure. The brand carries deep technology credibility as the pioneer of SiC (formerly Cree's Wolfspeed division). However, the bankruptcy filing in 2025 severely damaged the brand's market credibility and customer confidence.

Brand Identity Evolution: Wolfspeed rebranded from Cree in 2021, signaling a focus on power semiconductors (divesting the LED business that made Cree famous). The brand was positioned as "the enabler of the EV revolution" - but financial difficulties and the bankruptcy filing contradicted this aspirational positioning. Post-bankruptcy, the brand must rebuild from "technology leader that couldn't execute" to "restructured platform ready to deliver."

Marketing Leadership & Strategy: [INFERRED] Pre-bankruptcy marketing focused on EV and clean energy partnerships. Post-bankruptcy, marketing must pivot to rebuilding customer confidence - reassuring automotive OEMs and Tier 1 suppliers that Wolfspeed can fulfill long-term supply commitments.

Brand Threats: ON Semiconductor, Infineon, and STMicroelectronics are investing billions in competing SiC capacity. If Wolfspeed's post-bankruptcy operational recovery is slow, customers will qualify alternative suppliers - potentially permanently. The bankruptcy stigma in semiconductor manufacturing (where customers need 10+ year supply assurance) is severe.

McChrystal Connection: The brand recovery requires operational execution that proves the bankruptcy was a financial event, not a capability event. Every wafer shipped on-time, every yield improvement, every customer milestone met rebuilds brand credibility. McChrystal's operating discipline ensures the operational execution matches the brand recovery narrative.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Wolfspeed. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Post-Bankruptcy Organizational Rebuilding

Near-total leadership turnover (CEO, CFO, COO, board replaced in 12 months), manufacturing consolidation, and workforce trauma create an organization that must be rebuilt from the leadership level down. McChrystal's organizational design methodology builds the operating model for the new Wolfspeed. No consulting firm competes on post-crisis organizational rebuilding with the military credibility McChrystal brings.

Fit Dimension 2: Manufacturing Technology Transition Under Pressure

Transitioning from 150mm to 200mm SiC wafers while consolidating from multiple fabs to the Siler City mega-fab requires cross-functional coordination between R&D, manufacturing, supply chain, and customer qualification. McChrystal's operating rhythm ensures this technology transition doesn't stall during the organizational rebuilding.

Fit Dimension 3: Customer Confidence Restoration

Automotive OEMs with 5-10 year supply needs must be convinced that Wolfspeed can deliver post-bankruptcy. This requires visible operational discipline - on-time deliveries, yield improvements, and transparent communication. McChrystal's execution cadence provides the structured accountability that rebuilds customer trust.

9b. Cumulative Case

Wolfspeed is the most acute organizational rebuilding challenge in the pipeline - post-bankruptcy, near-total leadership replacement, manufacturing technology transition, and customer confidence crisis. Signal chain: Financial distress -> bankruptcy -> CEO/CFO/COO/board replaced -> manufacturing consolidation -> 150mm->200mm transition -> customer flight risk -> 4,000 employees with trauma. Revenue potential: \$300K initial, \$700K-\$1M deployment, \$200K ongoing. Total: \$1.2M-\$1.5M over 18 months.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Leadership Team Formation: An almost entirely new C-suite must build trust, shared language, and operating norms while simultaneously making existential decisions about manufacturing strategy and customer priorities. 2. Workforce Trauma and Retention: Bankruptcy creates deep psychological impact. Best engineers leave first. Retention requires more than compensation - it requires organizational stability and visible leadership. 3. Manufacturing Consolidation Execution: Moving from multiple fabs to the Siler City mega-fab requires coordinated equipment transfer, process qualification, workforce relocation, and customer re-qualification. 4. 150mm to 200mm Transition Risk: The technology transition is Wolfspeed's competitive bet. If yields on 200mm don't improve rapidly, the cost structure doesn't work and the business case collapses. 5. Customer Qualification Recovery: Automotive customers who paused qualification during bankruptcy must be re-engaged. Each customer requires a customized recovery plan. 6. Competitor Acceleration: ON Semi, Infineon, and STMicro are investing billions in SiC while Wolfspeed restructures. Every month of delay widens the competitive gap.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. New Leadership Team Alignment: Operating rhythm for the rebuilt C-suite. Measurable: leadership team effectiveness scores established and trending positive within 90 days. 2. Manufacturing Transition Coordination: Cross-functional cadence for fab consolidation and technology transition. Measurable: 200mm yield milestones on-track. 3. Customer Recovery Framework: Structured engagement program for priority automotive OEMs. Measurable: top 10 customer qualification programs restarted within 6 months. 4. Talent Stabilization: Retention framework for critical engineering talent. Measurable: voluntary attrition of key engineers below 10% during transition. 5. Organizational Resilience: Post-bankruptcy culture rebuilding. Measurable: employee engagement scores improving quarter-over-quarter.

9e. Key Stakeholders

CEO

Leader: [New CEO, post-bankruptcy]

Role: Organizational rebuilding

McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

CFO

Leader: [New CFO]
Role: Financial restructuring
McChrystal Relevance: Budget gatekeeper

COO

Leader: [New COO]
Role: Manufacturing operations
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Fab consolidation, technology transition

Chief People Officer

Leader: [CHRO]
Role: Talent retention, culture rebuilding
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Workforce stabilization

Sales/Customer

Leader: [VP Sales]
Role: Customer re-engagement
McChrystal Relevance: Customer confidence restoration

Board

Leader: [Reconstituted board]
Role: Governance, strategic oversight
McChrystal Relevance: Board-level introduction vector

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: Post-bankruptcy window - the new leadership team is forming NOW. Operating model decisions made in the first 6 months determine whether Wolfspeed recovers or fades. This is the most time-sensitive engagement window in the pipeline.

Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: AlixPartners handles the financial restructuring. McKinsey might advise on manufacturing strategy. But neither builds an organization from near-scratch. McChrystal's experience standing up new organizational structures in austere environments (military base building) is the direct analog to Wolfspeed's post-bankruptcy rebuilding.

Phased Engagement: Phase 1 (\$250K-\$350K): Leadership team alignment + operating model design for post-bankruptcy operations. Phase 2 (\$500K-\$700K): Manufacturing transition coordination + customer recovery framework. Phase 3 (\$200K retainer): Ongoing organizational development. Total: \$950K-\$1.3M.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit: New COO (manufacturing operations), CHRO (talent/culture), and board-level introduction. Semiconductor industry events (SEMICON); clean energy/EV industry connections.